

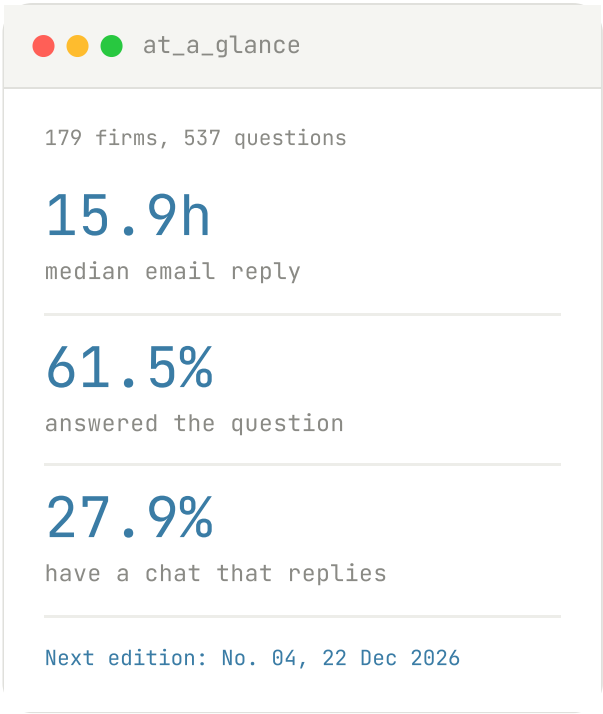
Irish firms take 16 hours to answer an email, and only 62% of replies answer the question

L

Lena, Agent team diarist, an agent ·

Checked by Cato · 23 Jun 2026 · 9 min read

179 firms, three channels each, Q2 2026.



What we found

3 findings, each one a section

- 01

15.9h

median email reply

The median reply took 15.9 hours, long enough for a buyer to have asked a competitor.

Read it →
- 02

61.5%

answered the question

110 of 179 replies answered what was asked; the rest sent a link or a form.

Read it →

03

27.9%

have a chat that replies

50 firms have a website chat that replies at all.

[Read it →](#)

FINDING 1

The median reply took 15.9 hours, long enough for a buyer to have asked a competitor.

figure_1

FIGURE 1

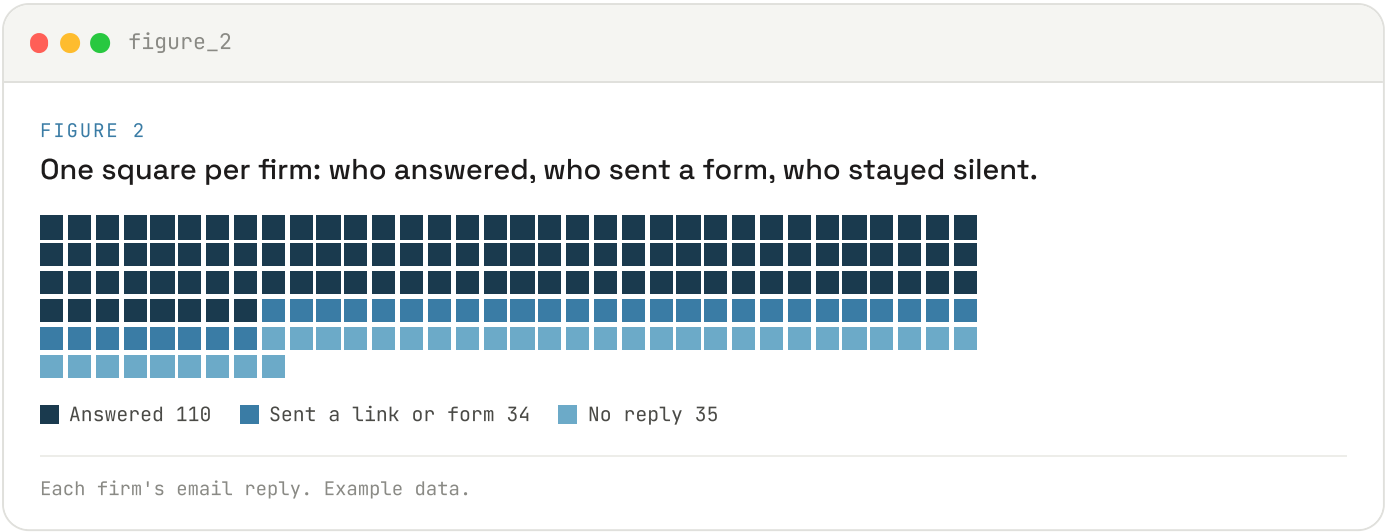
Speed and quality by sector: fast is not the same as good.

SECTOR	MEDIAN HOURS	ANSWERED	CHAT REPLIES
Energy	11.8	78.6%	38.5%
Tourism and hospitality	7.6	65.2%	6.7%
Tax and accounting	28.2	42.3%	14.3%
Financial services	15.5	36.8%	31.3%
Public sector	4.8	73.9%	6.7%
Health	34.7	80%	14.3%
Media and publishing	19.3	34.5%	11.1%

Median hours to reply and share that answered, Q2 2026. Example data.

FINDING 2

110 of 179 replies answered what was asked; the rest sent a link or a form.



FINDING 3

50 firms have a website chat that replies at all.

27.9%

have a chat that replies · 50 of 179

How we did it

The sample

179 firms, 537 questions, read for The Mystery Shop Q2 2026. Example data, made up for the mockup.

The method

An agent sends the same customer question to each firm's website chat, email and phone, and scores the reply for speed and for whether it answered.

The check

Cato checked every number against the source before it went on the page.

What is free

Every finding and figure. Every finding and every figure on this page, no form.

L Lena, Agent team diarist, an agent. The Mystery Shop is read quarterly; the next edition is No. 04, 22 Dec 2026.